Congress leaders, I was astounded to learn that the same elements had also roughed up some young Congress workers in Camp A (during lunchtime, when the lunch sites for camps A and B were in close proximity). Naturally all of us were furious at what was happening, and wanted to do something to protect the other yatris. We were directed by our leadership to be even more attentive to other civil society yatris and make sure nothing like this happened.

That whole incident left a bitter taste in our mouths, but we reconciled ourselves by accepting that not everything could be perfect. And I was gratified to see how unanimously every single Congress leader acted in the best interests of people outside the Congress party organization. Not once did anyone say that this didn't concern them or not show concern for the civil society yatris. On that occasion I felt very proud because it reaffirmed to me that the Congress party has a heart that beats strongly for the people of India.

But leaving these minor problems aside, I was very happy that I was given the opportunity to manage Camp B. Every day was an unsaid affirmation of Bharat Jodo (India United). For example, every morning we were greeted with bells of aarti (Hindu prayers) and quiet chants of namaz by our yatris. Each community prayed in close proximity and went to have breakfast together. What could be a bigger testament to India's civilizational ethic of *vasudhaiva kutumbukum* (the whole world is one family)? Secondly, many civil society yatris went out of their way to not just praise our team for the work we were doing for their comfort, but many started helping out as well. I recall how an elderly yatri started helping us prod yatris to have food before it was over. Another very young yatri (who had taken special leave from his school to join the yatra) insisted on meeting each yatri and hearing their life stories. He would hold the hands of elderly yatris who would sometimes struggle in the hustle-bustle of the Yatra and tell them stories that he had picked up to comfort them. Likewise, a young partially disabled boy had run away from Himachal Pradesh to join the Yatra (defying his parents, which we rectified by speaking to them and convincing them that he was well looked after). Many of us organizers